THE BUILDING PRACTICE LTD IT OPERATIONS MANUAL

(ERP, CAD/BIM, NETWORKS & SECURITY)

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Revision History

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SECTION 1 — INTRODUCTION & PURPOSE

1.1 Introduction

The Building Practice Ltd is a team of about 50 professionals dedicated to delivering high-quality architectural and construction solutions. We combine knowledge, skill, creativity, and modern technology to produce designs and built spaces that are functional, sustainable, and emotionally appealing. Our work covers architectural design, interior design, project management, real estate development, construction, and fire consultancy.

1.2 Purpose of this Manual

This IT Operations Manual provides clear guidance for all staff on how to use, manage, and protect the company's information systems. It ensures that:

- IT operations support smooth, reliable, and professional service delivery.
- Risks related to data, cyber-security, and IT equipment are controlled.
- Staff follow consistent procedures aligned with the company's quality and safety objectives.
- The company's digital assets and information are protected at all times.

1.3 ISO Alignment

This manual follows the principles of:

- **ISO 9001 (Quality Management Systems)** ensuring consistency, proper documentation, controlled processes, and continual improvement in IT operations.
- **ISO 45001 (Occupational Health and Safety Management Systems)** ensuring safe use of IT equipment, prevention of hazards, ergonomic considerations, and structured reporting of IT-related incidents.

1.4 Link to Company Vision & Mission

This manual supports the company's mission to deliver outstanding and sustainable buildings, and its vision to become a benchmark provider of architectural services across Africa and beyond. Effective IT systems help our teams work efficiently, safely, and collaboratively toward these goals.

SECTION 2 — SCOPE OF THE IT OPERATIONS MANUAL

2.1 Scope of Application

This IT Operations Manual applies to all staff, departments, projects, and offices of The Building Practice Ltd. It covers all activities that involve the use of company information systems, including:

- Desktop and laptop computers (office and remote use)
- Mobile devices, tablets, and site devices
- Local network systems and Wi-Fi infrastructure
- Internet access and VPN connections
- Email and communication platforms.
- Cloud storage, shared drives, and document management systems
- BIM, CAD, and architectural modeling systems (e.g., Revit, AutoCAD, etc)
- Project servers and collaborative design platforms (e.g., BIM360, Google Workspace, Microsoft Teams)
- IT security tools, authentication systems, and access control
- Backup and disaster recovery systems

2.2 Who Must Follow This Manual

This manual applies to:

- All full-time and part-time employees
- Project managers and supervisors
- Designers, architects, construction managers, and interns
- Remote workers and hybrid staff
- Contracted consultants and vendors accessing company systems
- Third-party service providers with temporary system access

2.3 Activities Covered

This manual governs all IT activities, including:

- Use of computers, devices, and company networks
- Use of BIM/CAD software and digital project files
- File sharing and storage practices
- Software installation, licensing, and updates
- Use of email, messaging, and communication tools
- Cybersecurity, password management, and access control
- Remote work procedures (VPN, secure access, data protection)
- Use of IT systems on construction sites
- Digital project documentation and version control
- Reporting and managing IT or safety incidents
- Business continuity and backup procedures

2.4 Remote Work / Work-From-Home Coverage

This manual applies fully to staff working remotely. This includes:

- Use of secure connections (VPN)
- Protecting confidential project files outside the office
- Ensuring devices used at home meet IT security standards
- Safe handling of BIM/CAD models that require high-performance systems
- Following all communication and documentation protocols

2.5 ISO Requirements Addressed

This section fulfills:

- ISO 9001 Clause 4.3 — Scope of the Quality Management System
- ISO 45001 Clause 4.3 — Scope of the OH&S Management System

SECTION 3 — ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES (INCLUDING ERP)

3.1 Information & Systems Manager (ISM)

The ISM is the overall authority for all IT and ERP-related activities in The Building Practice Ltd.

Key Responsibilities — IT & General Systems

- Oversee all IT operations and system performance.
- Maintain, update, and enforce the IT Operations Manual.
- Approve system access levels, passwords, and user account creation.
- Ensure cybersecurity, data protection, and backup procedures.
- Ensure safe use of IT equipment (ISO 45001 requirement).
- Approve installation, licensing, and updates of BIM/CAD software.
- Lead investigations into IT or cybersecurity incidents.

Key Responsibilities — ERP Implementation & Management

- Serve as the Internal ERP Lead for Odoo implementation.
- Coordinate with the Odoo ERP Implementation Lead (external consultant).
- Plan internal timelines, resource allocation, and departmental readiness.
- Oversee data migration, data cleaning, and master data setup.
- Approve user roles, privileges, and access levels within the ERP.
- Ensure ERP modules align with company processes (Quality, HR, Projects, Finance).
- Maintain ERP documentation and user manuals.
- Ensure ERP processes comply with ISO 9001: Document Control & Process Control.
- Ensure safety-related modules comply with ISO 45001: Incident Reporting & HSE Records.
- Monitor ERP performance and ensure continuous improvement.
- Lead internal ERP training sessions for all departments.

3.2 ERP Implementation Lead (Odoo Consultant)

An external consultant assigned by Odoo to guide the company through onboarding and implementation.

Key Responsibilities

- Configure, customize, and deploy ERP modules selected by the company.
- Provide technical support on setup, workflows, and integrations.
- Train the ISM and departmental champions.
- Support data migration and ensure correct mapping of old-to-new systems.
- Provide documentation, technical notes, and change logs.
- Assist with testing, pilot runs, and go-live preparation.
- Report unresolved risks or issues to the ISM.

3.3 HR, Accounts, and Projects Teams (Departmental Users)

These teams are the primary business owners of ERP modules (HR, Accounting, Projects).

Key Responsibilities

- Participate in ERP onboarding and training sessions.
- Provide accurate operational data for migration (employees, vendors, tasks, etc.).
- Test workflows in their assigned modules before go-live.
- Follow new processes defined in the ERP.
- Report errors or workflow issues to the ISM.
- Use the ERP consistently for daily operations.
- Maintain record accuracy according to ISO 9001 (Documented Information).
- Ensure safe usage of devices and ERP systems (ISO 45001).

3.4 Department Heads / Unit Leaders

Leaders ensure smooth adoption of IT and ERP systems within their units.

Responsibilities

- Ensure their team complies with IT & ERP procedures.
- Approve ERP access requests based on job roles.
- Communicate operational needs or workflow changes to the ISM.
- Enforce proper file management and data quality.
- Identify staff requiring additional training or onboarding.
- Monitor project or departmental ERP usage.

3.5 All Employees (General Staff)

Every staff member must comply with IT and ERP policies.

Responsibilities

- Use IT and ERP systems responsibly and securely.
- Protect login credentials and avoid password sharing.
- Store files in approved ERP modules or cloud drives.
- Follow BIM/CAD file control and versioning rules.
- Report IT or ERP incidents immediately.
- Participate in required ERP training.
- Follow health and safety rules when using IT equipment.

3.6 Executive Management

Management provides strategic direction and support for IT & ERP initiatives.

Responsibilities

- Approve major ERP and IT investments.
- Support change management efforts during implementation.
- Review ERP performance and process improvement outcomes.
- Ensure availability of financial and personnel resources.
- Reinforce company-wide compliance with ISO 9001 and ISO 45001.

ISO Alignment Notes

This section fulfills:

- ISO 9001 Clause 5.3 — Organizational Roles and Responsibilities
- ISO 9001 Clause 7.1.3 — Infrastructure (including ERP and IT)
- ISO 45001 Clause 5.3 — OH&S Roles and Responsibilities

SECTION 4 — IT GOVERNANCE & POLICY FRAMEWORK (WITH ERP)

4.1 Overview of IT Governance

IT Governance ensures that all information systems — including ERP, BIM, CAD tools, email, cloud storage, and servers — support the company's strategic goals.

The governance structure for The Building Practice Ltd is built on:

- ISO 9001 quality requirements
- ISO 45001 safety requirements
- Data security and confidentiality
- Efficient workflow and documentation control
- Safe and secure use of IT systems

4.2 Core IT Governance Principles

1. **Confidentiality** — All company data (drawings, client info, finances, HR records) must be protected.
2. **Integrity** — No unauthorized editing or deletion of files, ERP data, or CAD resources.
3. **Availability** — Systems must be accessible when needed for work.
4. **Accountability** — Staff are responsible for proper system usage.
5. **Standardization** — Use approved tools, storage locations, file formats, and ERP workflows.
6. **Safety** — All use of IT equipment must comply with occupational health & safety standards.

4.3 Governance Structure

Information & Systems Manager

- Oversees governance for all IT systems and the hybrid ERP structure.
- Ensures compliance with ISO requirements.
- Approves system access, data permissions, backup strategies, and IT policies.

ERP Implementation Lead (Odoo Consultant)

- Supports technical configuration and onboarding.
- Ensures ERP processes align with global standards and best practices.

Departmental Heads

- Enforce governance in their teams.
- Approve user access levels in ERP, BIM, email systems, and shared folders.

All Employees

- Must comply with approved workflows and system rules.
- Must use ERP, shared drives, or BIM servers exactly as instructed.

4.4 Where ERP Fits in Governance (Support + Hybrid Model)

Since the ERP is not replacing technical engineering tools, its governance role is:

ERP Supports:

- HR management
- Timesheets
- Project costing
- Finance & invoicing
- Procurement
- Document tracking
- Operations processes
- Asset management

External Systems Continue Handling:

- AutoCAD / Revit / BIM 360
- Render files
- Construction site data
- Structural / MEP drawings
- Photography and large media files
- Local servers or cloud drives

ERP + Existing Tools Must Work Together

- Staff must not split information randomly between systems.
- Each system has a defined purpose.

4.5 IT Policies Included in Governance

- Acceptable Use Policy
- Password & Authentication Policy
- Software Installation Policy
- Data Backup Policy
- ERP Usage Policy
- Email & Communication Policy
- Cybersecurity Policy
- Incident Reporting Policy
- Mobile Device Policy
- Remote Work Policy
- CAD/BIM File Management Policy
- Health & Safety (IT workstation) Policy

SECTION 5 — DATA MANAGEMENT & BACKUP PROCEDURES (WITH ERP INTEGRATION)

5.1 General Data Management Rules

- All company data belongs to The Building Practice Ltd.
- Only approved platforms may be used (ERP, cloud drives, BIM servers).
- No storing of company data on personal laptops, phones, or USBs.
- File names must follow approved formats (especially drawings: e.g., TBP-PROJ-REV).
- Version control must be followed for BIM/CAD files.

5.2 ERP Data Management

The ERP stores:

- HR information
- Leave requests
- Timesheets
- Project budgets
- Vendor lists
- Client lists
- Invoices
- Proposals
- Procurement records
- Document metadata (NOT heavy file storage)

ERP Data Rules:

- Only the ISM can create new user accounts.
- HR, Accounts, and Projects teams maintain their module data.
- All entries must be accurate — ISO 9001 requires controlled documented information.
- No duplicate records.
- All transactions must be entered at the time of action (not later).

5.3 Backup Strategy

To comply with ISO standards:

ERP Backups (Cloud-based Odoo)

- Automatic daily backups (handled by Odoo cloud).
- Weekly offsite backup retained by Odoo.
- ISM downloads monthly snapshots and stores them in secure cloud storage.

Design/CAD/BIM Backups

- Daily server backup.
- Weekly consolidated backup to cloud storage.
- Versioned backups for large files.
- No editing files directly from cloud storage.
- Revit central models must follow proper sync rules.

Email/Document Backups

- Managed via the company's email provider.
- Archival done every quarter by the ISM.

SECTION 6 — CYBERSECURITY & ACCESS CONTROL (WITH ERP INTEGRATION)

6.1 Security Principles

- Access is granted based on job role only.
- Every system (ERP, email, CAD server, Wi-Fi) requires authentication.
- Passwords must be strong and changed every 90 days.
- MFA (Two-Factor Authentication) must be used where available.

6.2 ERP Access Security

- Only the ISM manages ERP user accounts.
- Department Heads approve new access for their staff.
- Access levels (View / Create / Edit / Approve) follow the RACI structure.
- Accounts must be disabled immediately when a staff member exits.
- No sharing of ERP passwords or sessions.

6.3 Device Security

- All company laptops must use passwords and auto-lock.
- Antivirus and system updates must be enabled.
- Staff must report stolen devices immediately.

6.4 Network & Server Security

- Wi-Fi access is restricted based on role (Guest / Staff / Admin networks).
- Project servers and BIM servers must only be accessed via authorized laptops.
- No personal devices may be connected to internal networks without permission.

6.5 Incident Reporting

Staff must report immediately if they notice:

- Strange system behavior
- Lost or stolen devices
- Unauthorized access attempts
- ERP errors that affect data
- Viruses or suspicious emails
- Accidental deletion of files

SECTION 7 — SOFTWARE, HARDWARE & ASSET MANAGEMENT

7.1 Approved Software List

The Building Practice Ltd uses only licensed and approved software. No staff is allowed to install or use personal or unapproved software.

A) Core Business Software (Company-Wide)

- Microsoft Office / Google Workspace
- Email platform (official company domain)
- Odoo ERP (cloud)
- PDF editors and viewers
- Antivirus/Endpoint protection

B) Approved CAD/BIM & Design Software

For the design department, AutoCAD and Revit are the official tools:

AutoCAD (2D Drafting)

- Used for architectural drafting.
- Used for detailing and documentation.
- Must follow company drawing standards.

Revit (BIM Modeling)

- Used for 3D BIM modelling.
- Central File & Work-sharing rules must be followed.
- Used for project coordination.
- Files must stay on the approved BIM server or cloud system.

No other design software (e.g., SketchUp, ArchiCAD, Rhino) may be used unless approved by the Information & Systems Manager.

7.2 Hardware Standards

Approved hardware includes:

A) Laptops & Workstations

- i5/i7/i9 processors (minimum)
- 16–32GB RAM for CAD/BIM work
- Dedicated GPU (for Revit teams)
- SSD storage

B) Monitors

- Dual-monitor setup recommended for design staff.
- Eye-level positioning must follow ISO 45001 ergonomic guidelines.

C) Networking Equipment

- Company routers, switches, firewalls.
- No personal MiFi or hotspots for company systems without approval.

7.3 Software Installation Rules

- Only the Information & Systems Manager can install software.
- Staff must not download any software (free or paid) without approval.
- Software must be updated regularly to maintain security and performance.
- Expired licenses must be reported immediately.

7.4 Hardware Assignment & Tracking

- All laptops, monitors, and accessories are company property.
- The ISM must maintain an asset register that includes:
    i. Serial number
    ii. Assigned user
    iii. Date issued
    iv. Warranty status
    v. Condition
- Staff must sign an IT Asset Hand-Over Form when receiving or returning devices.

7.5 CAD/BIM File Management Rules

For AutoCAD

- Use standard layers and templates.
- Save files using approved naming conventions.
- Store DWG files ONLY in the project's assigned folder.
- No saving to desktop or personal folders.

For Revit

- Only the ISM or BIM Lead can create new central models.
- All team members must sync regularly and avoid overwriting.
- No direct editing of linked models.
- Use company-approved Revit families and materials.
- Large renderings must be saved in dedicated "Renders" folders to avoid clogging project directories.

7.6 ERP, CAD, and Cloud System Integration

The structure is:

- **ERP:** HR, Finance, Projects, Procurement.
- **AutoCAD/Revit:** Technical work.
- **Cloud Storage/BIM Server:** Large file management.

Rules:

- ERP stores records, not heavy CAD files.
- All technical drawings must be linked inside the ERP via references (not uploaded).
- Teams must ensure:
    - CAD/Revit is the source of truth for design.
    - ERP is the source of truth for project costing, timelines, and documentation tracking.

7.7 Mobile Device ERP Access Policy

Building Practice Ltd allows ERP access from mobile devices (company-issued phones and tablets) to support field operations, onsite supervision, HR tasks, and real-time project updates. ERP access levels on mobile devices follow a controlled, role-based policy.

A) Full ERP Access (All Modules)

Full access is granted ONLY to:

- Executive Management
- Information & Systems Manager (ISM)
- Project Managers / Senior Site Supervisors
- HR Department
- Accounts / Finance Department
- Admin / Operations Management

Full access includes:

- HR module
- Accounts/Finance
- Procurement
- Projects
- Timesheets
- Documents
- Assets
- Approvals
- Internal communication modules

Purpose:
These roles require complete visibility and decision-making authority across multiple functions.

B) Limited ERP Access (Projects Module Only)

Limited access users include:

- Junior site supervisors
- Site engineers
- Assistant project coordinators
- Technical officers
- Graduate trainees
- Interns (project-related roles)

Limited access includes:

- Viewing project tasks
- Updating site activities
- Uploading site photos
- Checking timelines
- Recording issues or site notes
- Accessing safety forms (ISO 45001)
- Timesheet submission
- Viewing assigned documents

No access to:

- HR files
- Procurement
- Money-related modules
- Approvals
- Sensitive documents

C) General Rules for Mobile ERP Access

All staff using ERP on a mobile device must:

- Enable PIN + biometric lock.
- Never share ERP login details.
- Avoid using ERP while walking on site (ISO 45001 safety requirement).
- Report any security issue immediately.
- Sync data only through secure company networks.
- Avoid storing documents locally on the device.
- Use only company-approved apps with ERP.

D) Device Loss or Theft

If a mobile device with ERP access is lost:

1. Report immediately to the Information & Systems Manager.
2. ISM will lock the ERP session.
3. ISM will remove the device from trusted devices.
4. HR and Security will be notified (ISO compliance requirement).
5. A replacement device is only issued after internal review.

SECTION 8 — NETWORK & INFRASTRUCTURE OPERATIONS

8.1 Purpose

This section defines how The Building Practice Ltd manages its IT network and infrastructure to ensure secure, reliable access to ERP, design tools, email, and shared files.

8.2 Components Covered

This section applies to:

- Local Area Network (LAN) and cabling
- Wi-Fi networks (Staff, Guest, Admin)
- Internet connections and routers/firewalls
- VPN (remote access)
- On-premise servers and network storage
- Networked printers and scanners
- Power protection (UPS for servers and network equipment)

8.3 Network Design & Segmentation

- The ISM designs and maintains the network structure.
- Networks are segmented to reduce risk:
    - **Admin Network** — servers, ERP access points, core infrastructure.
    - **Staff Network** — staff laptops and desktops.
    - **Guest Network** — visitors and personal devices, internet only.
- Only authorized devices can connect to Admin and Staff networks.

8.4 Network Use Rules

- Staff may connect only company-approved devices to the Staff network.
- Guest network is for visitors and personal devices; no access to internal servers.
- No unauthorized Wi-Fi routers, hotspots, or repeaters are allowed.
- Streaming and large personal downloads are prohibited on office networks.

8.5 Remote Access & VPN

- Remote access to internal servers (e.g., BIM/CAD storage) must use the approved VPN.
- VPN accounts are created and removed by the ISM only.
- Staff must disconnect VPN when not in use.
- Public Wi-Fi may only be used with VPN enabled.

8.6 Server & Cloud Infrastructure

- Project files and Revit central models are stored on approved servers or cloud drives.
- ERP (Odoo) is cloud-hosted; availability depends on internet connection and vendor SLA.
- The ISM maintains a network diagram and inventory of all active equipment.

8.7 Performance & Capacity Management

- The ISM monitors:

- Internet bandwidth usage.
- Server storage capacity.
- Network device health (routers, switches, Wi-Fi access points).
- Capacity upgrades are planned ahead of time and approved by Executive Management.

8.8 Maintenance & Changes

- Only the ISM or authorized vendors may:

- Change network configurations.
- Install or move network devices.
- Open/close firewall ports.
- All major changes must be documented (date, reason, devices affected) and stored in the IT records (ERP or shared drive).

8.9 Physical Security of Infrastructure

- Network cabinets, routers, and servers must be locked and accessible only to authorized staff.

1. Server rooms or network cabinets must be:

2. Well-ventilated.
3. Protected from water, dust, and physical damage.
4. Free of stored materials that could cause fire or trips.

8.10 ISO Alignment

- ISO 9001: 7.1.3 (Infrastructure), 8.5.1 (Control of Production & Service Provision)

- ISO 45001: 7.1.3 (Infrastructure safety), 8.1 (Operational control)

SECTION 9 — EMAIL & COMMUNICATION SYSTEMS

9.1 Official Communication Tools

The Building Practice Ltd uses the following official tools:

- Company email (e.g., Google Workspace / Microsoft 365)
- Microsoft Teams / Google Chat (or similar)
- Odoo ERP internal messaging and notifications
- Approved video conferencing tools (e.g., Teams, Zoom, Google Meet)

Any other tools (e.g., WhatsApp) are supplementary only and must not replace official records.

9.2 Acceptable Use

Staff must:

- Use company email for all official business communication.
- Use professional language and proper formatting.
- Include standard email signature (name, title, contacts).
- Use "Reply All" only when necessary.

Staff must NOT:

- Use personal email accounts for company business.
- Send offensive, discriminatory, or inappropriate content.
- Subscribe company email addresses to unrelated mailing lists.

9.3 Confidentiality & Attachments

- Confidential documents (drawings, contracts, HR or finance data) must be sent via:

Company email with secure links to shared drives or ERP docs, rather than large attachments where possible.

- Sensitive documents must not be forwarded to personal addresses.
- External recipients must be verified before sending any confidential information.

9.4 Use of Chat & Collaboration Tools

- Teams/Chat are used for quick communication, not as the final storage for official documents.

- Important decisions or approvals must be recorded in:

1. Email, or
2. ERP workflows (e.g., approvals, purchase orders), or
3. Signed documents.

- Project groups/channels must use clear naming and be archived when projects close.

9.5 Odoo ERP Internal Messaging

- ERP notifications (e.g., approvals, tasks, timesheets) are official records.
- Staff must check ERP inbox/notifications daily.
- HR, Accounts, and Projects teams must document approvals and workflow steps through ERP where configured.

9.6 Record Retention

- Email accounts and chat histories are retained in line with the company's record retention policy.
- HR and legal-related communications may be archived for longer periods as required.

9.7 Prohibited Uses

- Sending or storing pirated software or media.
- Sending chain letters, bulk spam, or mass unsolicited messages.
- Sharing client or company-sensitive data with unauthorized recipients.

9.8 ISO Alignment

- ISO 9001: 7.4 (Communication), 8.2.1 (Customer communication), 7.5 (Documented information)
- ISO 45001: 7.4 (Communication, participation and consultation)

SECTION 10 — HEALTH & SAFETY IN IT USE (ISO 45001 FOCUS)

10.1 Purpose

To ensure safe and healthy use of IT equipment in the office, at home, and on construction sites, in line with ISO 45001.

10.2 Ergonomic Workstation Setup

- Chair height must allow feet flat on the floor and knees at approximately 90°.
- Monitor top edge at or slightly below eye level, at arm's length distance.
- Keyboard and mouse positioned so elbows are close to the body and wrists straight.
- Dual monitors should be at equal height; main monitor centered.
- Staff should take short breaks (1–2 minutes) every 30–45 minutes to stretch and rest eyes.

10.3 Safe Use of Laptops & Mobile Devices

- Staff must not:

- Use phones or tablets while walking on site.
- Use devices while driving or operating machinery.
- Laptops must not be used on unstable surfaces (e.g., edges, railings).
- On site, devices must be kept in protective cases and away from water, dust, and moving equipment.

10.4 Electrical Safety

- Only approved power strips and surge protectors may be used.
- Do not overload sockets or daisy-chain extension leads.
- Damaged chargers, cables, or plugs must be reported and replaced immediately.
- Only qualified personnel or vendors may open IT hardware or work on electrical points.

10.5 Cable Management & Trip Hazards

- Cables must be routed to avoid walkways where possible.
- Loose or trailing cables must be secured (cable covers, ties).
- Any cable-related near-misses (e.g., someone almost tripped) must be reported as HSE incidents.

10.6 Screen Time & Wellbeing

- Prolonged continuous screen use should be avoided; micro-breaks are encouraged.

- Staff should report any discomfort (eye strain, neck/back pain) to HR or HSE representatives.
- Workload planning must consider reasonable use of IT without excessive overtime.

10.7 Remote Work Health & Safety

- Remote workers must:
    - Set up a safe and ergonomic workspace at home.
    - Keep cables and equipment away from children and pets.
    - Follow all electrical and device safety rules as in the office.

10.8 Reporting IT-Related Safety Incidents

- Any incident involving IT equipment (electric shock, tripping, device fire/smoke, near-miss) must be reported using:
- The company HSE / incident reporting form (preferably via ERP), and
- Directly to the Department Head and ISM.

10.9 ISO Alignment

- ISO 45001: 6.1 (Hazard identification), 7.2 (Competence), 7.3 (Awareness), 8.1 (Operational control), 8.2 (Emergency preparedness and response)

SECTION 11 — INCIDENT MANAGEMENT PROCEDURE (IT & ERP)

11.1 Purpose

To ensure all IT and ERP-related incidents are reported, investigated, and resolved in a controlled and documented way.

11.2 Definitions

- **IT Incident:** Any unplanned interruption or reduction in the quality of an IT service (e.g., server down, network outage).
- **Security Incident:** Any event that compromises confidentiality, integrity, or availability of information (e.g., malware, unauthorized access).
- **Near-Miss:** An event that could have led to an incident but did not (e.g., suspicious email opened but no harm).

11.3 Scope

Covers incidents involving:

- ERP (Odoo), email, and cloud services
- CAD/BIM servers and files
- Laptops, mobile devices, and network equipment
- Cybersecurity (phishing, viruses, data breaches)
- IT-related safety incidents (e.g., electric shock, trip hazards)

11.4 Responsibilities

- **All Employees:** Detect and report incidents immediately.
- **ISM:** Log, assess, coordinate response, and manage technical recovery.
- **Department Heads:** Support investigation, ensure staff cooperation, implement corrective actions in their teams.
- **Executive Management:** Approve major corrective actions and communicate externally if needed.

11.5 Reporting Procedure (For All Staff)

1. **Stop and Contain (if safe to do so):**

- Disconnect affected device from network (Wi-Fi/LAN) if malware is suspected.
- Do not delete suspicious files or emails; leave evidence intact.

2. **Report Immediately:**

- Notify the ISM (call, chat, or email to a dedicated IT support address).
- Inform your Department Head if the incident affects project delivery or safety.

Provide Basic Details:

- Your name and department.
- Date and time.
- System/device involved.
- What you observed and actions already taken.

11.6 Logging & Classification

- The ISM logs all incidents in an Incident Register (in ERP or shared log).
- Incidents are classified by impact:
    - **Critical (P1):** Major service outage, suspected data breach, or safety risk.
    - **High (P2):** Serious disruption but limited scope.
    - **Medium (P3):** Localized issue with workaround available.
    - **Low (P4):** Minor issue, no real impact.

11.7 Investigation & Resolution

- ISM (with support from vendors where needed) will:
- Diagnose root cause.
- Restore service as quickly as possible.
- Recover data from backups if required.
- Apply security measures (password reset, account lock, patching).

11.8 Communication

- ISM informs affected users about:
- Incident status.
- Workarounds (if any).
- When normal service is restored.
- Only Executive Management or designated persons may communicate externally (e.g., to clients) about major incidents.

11.9 Post-Incident Review & Corrective Action

For critical and major incidents, the ISM and relevant Department Head must:

- Conduct a short review (what happened, why, what can be improved).
- Identify corrective and preventive actions (e.g., new controls, extra training).
- Record the actions in ERP or the corrective action log and track completion.

11.10 ISO Alignment

- ISO 9001: 8.7 (Control of nonconforming outputs), 10.2 (Nonconformity and corrective action)
- ISO 45001: 10.2 (Incident investigation and corrective action)

SECTION 12 — BUSINESS CONTINUITY & DISASTER RECOVERY

12.1 Purpose

To ensure The Building Practice Ltd can continue critical operations and recover IT services after a disruption or disaster.

12.2 Typical Risk Scenarios

- Loss of internet connectivity
- Power outage or electrical failure
- Server or storage failure
- Ransomware or major cyber-attack
- Fire, flood, or physical damage to office
- Odoo ERP cloud outage

12.3 Critical Systems & Priorities

Recovery priority is roughly:

1. Email and communication systems
2. ERP (Odoo) — HR, Finance, Projects, Procurement
3. CAD/BIM servers and project file storage
4. VPN and remote access
5. Shared cloud drives and archives

12.4 Recovery Objectives (General Guidelines)

- **ERP & Email:** Restore access as soon as vendor service resumes; interim communication via alternate channels (e.g., phone, SMS).
- **CAD/BIM Files:** Restore from latest daily backup where required.
- **RPO (data loss tolerance):** Maximum 24 hours for project and ERP data.
- **RTO (time to restore):**
- Critical services: within 24 hours where feasible.
- Non-critical services: within 3–5 days.

12.5 Continuity Strategies

- Cloud-based ERP ensures offsite resilience; vendor manages high availability and backups.
- Regular offline backups of key data (Section 5) provide restore capability.
- Laptops allow staff to relocate or work remotely if the office is unavailable.
- UPS and surge protection for servers and network devices minimize damage from power events.

12.6 Disaster Recovery Procedures (High Level)

In a major disruption:

1. ISM assesses impact and notifies Executive Management.
2. Activate alternate communication channel (e.g., staff WhatsApp broadcast, phone tree).
3. Switch to remote work where possible if office is unavailable.
4. Restore data from backups (ERP snapshots, BIM/CAD backups, email archives) as needed.
5. Document all recovery steps and decisions.

12.7 Roles & Responsibilities

- **ISM:** Leads technical recovery, coordinates with vendors, maintains DR documentation.
- **Department Heads:** Confirm business priorities, coordinate staff activities during disruption.
- **Executive Management:** Decide on major actions (temporary closure, client communication).

12.8 Testing & Review

- The ISM should conduct at least one annual test of a key recovery process (e.g., restoring a backup, VPN failover).
- Test results and improvement actions must be recorded and reviewed by Management.

12.9 ISO Alignment

- ISO 9001: 6.1 (Actions to address risks and opportunities), 8.2 & 8.5 (Operational planning and control)
- ISO 45001: 8.2 (Emergency preparedness and response)

SECTION 13 — DOCUMENT CONTROL (ISO 9001 CLAUSE 7.5)

13.1 Purpose

To ensure all IT and ERP-related documents and records are controlled, up to date, and accessible to authorized staff only.

13.2 Documents Covered

- Policies and procedures (including this IT Operations Manual)
- Work instructions and user guides (e.g., ERP use, Revit standards)
- Templates and forms (incident report, asset hand-over, access request)
- Network diagrams and system configurations
- Vendor contracts and service agreements

13.3 Document Creation & Approval

- **Drafting:** By ISM or designated process owner.
- **Review:** Department Heads and/or Quality Manager (where applicable).
- **Approval:** Executive Management or delegated authority.
- No uncontrolled drafts may be used in operations.

13.4 Identification & Versioning

Each controlled document must have:

- Title
- Unique document code (e.g., IT-OPS-001)
- Version / revision number
- Date of issue
- Author and approver
- Status (Draft / Approved / Obsolete)

13.5 Storage & Access

- Approved documents are stored in:

- ERP Document module, and/or
- Controlled shared drive with restricted write access.
- Staff are given read-only access to official procedures and templates.

13.6 Review & Update

- Key documents (including this manual) must be reviewed at least annually or after major changes in systems or standards.
- Changes must be tracked, with a short "Revision History" table.

13.7 Control of Obsolete Documents

- Obsolete versions must be:

1. Removed from active folders, and
2. Archived in an "Obsolete" folder clearly labelled as superseded.

- Only the latest approved version may be used in daily work.

13.8 Control of Records

- Records (completed forms, logs, incident reports, training attendance) must be:

- Legible, accurate, and retrievable.
- Stored in ERP, shared drives, or other approved systems.
- Retained for defined periods (per company retention policy).

13.9 External Documents

- External documents such as standards, codes, vendor manuals must be:

- Identified (title, version, source).
- Kept updated where relevant.
- Accessible to staff who need them.

13.10 ISO Alignment

- ISO 9001: 7.5 (Documented Information)

- ISO 45001: 7.5 (Documented Information for OH&S)

SECTION 14 — TRAINING & AWARENESS REQUIREMENTS

14.1 Purpose

To ensure all staff are competent and aware of their responsibilities when using IT, ERP, and BIM/CAD systems.

14.2 Induction Training

All new employees must receive induction that covers:

- Overview of IT systems (ERP, email, CAD/BIM servers)
- Basic cybersecurity (passwords, phishing, safe browsing)
- Acceptable use of devices and networks
- Health & safety requirements for IT equipment
- How to report IT issues and incidents

14.3 Role-Specific Training

- **Design Staff:**

- AutoCAD and Revit standards.
- File naming and version control.
- BIM collaboration rules.

- **ERP Users (HR, Accounts, Projects, Procurement):**

- Module-specific workflows.
- Data entry standards and approvals.
- Use of ERP for records and document control.

- **Managers:**

- Approvals in ERP.
- Monitoring reports and dashboards.
- Incident and risk escalation.

14.4 Cybersecurity & Data Protection Awareness

At least annually, staff must receive refresher awareness on:

- Recognizing phishing and suspicious links.
- Secure password practices and MFA.
- Safe use of USBs and external drives (if allowed).
- Remote work and VPN use.
- Reporting suspected data breaches immediately.

14.5 Health & Safety Awareness (IT-Related)

- Ergonomic workstation setup.
- Safe cable management and electrical safety.

- Safe use of devices on construction sites.
- Reporting IT-related safety incidents and near-misses.

14.6 Training Methods

- Classroom or virtual sessions.
- On-the-job coaching and demonstrations.
- Short guides, how-to videos, and FAQs.
- Toolbox talks (especially for site staff using mobile devices).

14.7 Training Records & Competence

- HR, with ISM support, maintains training records in the ERP HR module or other approved system.
- Where necessary, short tests, practical tasks, or supervisor observations may be used to confirm competence.

14.8 ISO Alignment

- ISO 9001: 7.2 (Competence), 7.3 (Awareness)
- ISO 45001: 7.2 (Competence), 7.3 (Awareness)

SECTION 15 — APPENDICES & STANDARD FORMS

The following standard forms support this IT Operations Manual. They may be implemented as:

- Digital forms/workflows in ERP, or
- Editable templates stored on the controlled shared drive.

15.1 IT Asset Hand-Over / Return Form

Fields (minimum):

- Employee name, department
- Asset type (laptop, monitor, phone, accessories)
- Brand, model, serial number
- Date issued / returned
- Condition on issue / return
- Employee signature
- ISM / Admin signature

15.2 IT & ERP Access Request Form

Fields:

- Employee name, job title, department
- Type of access requested (Email, ERP modules, network, VPN, BIM server)
- Justification
- Department Head approval
- ISM approval and date of account creation

15.3 IT / Security Incident Report Form

Fields:

- Reporter name and contact
- Date and time of incident
- Location (office/site/remote)
- Systems/devices affected
- Incident type (IT outage, data issue, security, HSE-related)
- Description of what happened
- Immediate actions taken
- Impact (none / minor / major)
- ISM investigation notes
- Root cause (if known)
- Corrective & preventive actions
- Closure date and approver

15.4 Backup & Restore Log Template

Fields:

- Date and time of backup/restore
- System backed up (ERP snapshot, BIM server, email, etc.)
- Type (full, incremental, test restore)
- Location of backup (cloud, external drive)
- Performed by
- Result (success/failure, notes)

15.5 Training Attendance & Competence Record

Fields:

- Training title and topic
- Date and duration
- Trainer name
- Participants list (name, department, role)
- Key learning objectives
- Assessment method (if any)
- Trainer/manager confirmation of competence

15.6 Remote Work / Mobile ERP Access Authorization

Fields:

- Employee name and role
- Type of remote access (VPN, ERP mobile, email)
- Devices authorized (serial number, type)
- Conditions (e.g., must use screen lock, VPN, approved Wi-Fi)
- Department Head approval
- ISM approval

15.7 Reference: Example CAD/Revit File Naming Convention

Example format:

- Project Code – Discipline – Drawing Type – Sequential Number – Revision
    - e.g., TBP123-AR-PLN-001-RevA

Central Revit Models:

- PROJCODE_Stage_Discipline_Central.rvt

These templates should be adapted to match company branding, legal requirements, and integration with Odoo ERP workflows.